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Lot

Abraham's nephew, who chose the well-watered plain and was pulled out of Sodom by the hand.

Lot was Abraham's nephew, the son of his brother Haran, who died in Ur. He traveled with his uncle into Canaan and grew rich alongside him. When their herds became too large to share the land, Abram let Lot choose first. Lot chose the green plain near Sodom, a city known for great wickedness. Step by step he moved closer, until he sat in Sodom's gate. When God judged the city, angels had to take Lot by the hand and lead him out. Yet the New Testament calls him "just Lot," a righteous man troubled by the evil around him.

At a glance

Name	Hebrew <i>Lot</i> . Its meaning is uncertain
Family	Son of Haran; nephew of Abraham; two daughters
Key places	Ur, Haran, Bethel, the Jordan plain, Sodom, Zoar
Key people	Abraham, Sarah, the king of Sodom, two angels, his wife and daughters
Descendants	The Moabites and the Ammonites (Genesis 19:37–38)
Main passages	Genesis 11:27–31; 12:4–5; 13:1–14:16; 19:1–38
New Testament	Luke 17:28–32; 2 Peter 2:6–9

"And while he lingered, the men laid hold upon his hand, and upon the hand of his wife, and upon the hand of his two daughters; the LORD being merciful unto him: and they brought him forth, and set him without the city."

Genesis 19:16, KJV

The life of Lot

Genesis gives no dates or ages for Lot. The order below follows the text.

In Ur	● Loses his father Lot's father Haran dies in Ur of the Chaldees. Terah takes his grandson Lot with Abram and Sarai toward Canaan, and they settle in Haran. <i>Genesis 11:27-31</i>
Leaving Haran	● Goes with Abram When Abram obeys God's call, "Lot went with him." They arrive in Canaan and later return together from Egypt, both rich in flocks and herds. <i>Genesis 12:4-5; 13:1-5</i>
Near Bethel	● Chooses the plain Their herdsmen quarrel. Abram offers Lot his pick of the land, and Lot chooses the well-watered plain of the Jordan and pitches his tent toward Sodom. <i>Genesis 13:6-13</i>
In Sodom	● Taken captive Four eastern kings defeat Sodom and carry off Lot, now living in the city. Abram pursues them, rescues Lot and brings back his goods. <i>Genesis 14:11-16</i>
In Sodom	● Receives two angels Lot takes two visitors into his house. The men of the city surround it, and the angels strike them with blindness and warn Lot to leave. <i>Genesis 19:1-14</i>
At dawn	● Led out Lot lingers, and the angels take him, his wife and his daughters by the hand. Fire falls on Sodom and Gomorrah. His wife looks back and becomes a pillar of salt. <i>Genesis 19:15-26</i>
In a cave	● A shameful end Afraid to stay in Zoar, Lot lives in a mountain cave. His daughters make him drunk and conceive by him. Their sons become the fathers of Moab and Ammon. <i>Genesis 19:30-38</i>

Key activities

Genesis 19:8 records that Lot offered his daughters to the mob to protect his guests. Scripture reports this without approving it. Many readers see in it how deeply life in Sodom had shaped him.

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- 1 **Followed his uncle.** He went with Abram from Haran into Canaan and shared in his blessing. *Genesis 12:4-5; 13:5*
 - 2 **Chose by sight.** He "lifted up his eyes" and chose the richest land, even though the men of Sodom were "wicked and sinners before the LORD exceedingly." *Genesis 13:10-13*
 - 3 **Moved into Sodom.** He first pitched his tent toward Sodom, then lived in the city and sat in its gate. *Genesis 13:12; 14:12; 19:1*
 - 4 **Welcomed strangers.** He urged two travelers to stay under his roof and baked them a meal. *Genesis 19:1-3*
 - 5 **Stood at the door.** He went out to the crowd and pleaded, "Do not so wickedly," but his own offer was shameful. *Genesis 19:4-9*
 - 6 **Warned his family.** He urged his sons-in-law to flee, but they thought he was joking. *Genesis 19:12-14*
 - 7 **Lingered.** Even at the last moment he hesitated, and the angels pulled him out "the LORD being merciful unto him." *Genesis 19:15-16*
 - 8 **Bargained for Zoar.** He asked to flee to a small town instead of the mountains, and the angel spared it for his sake. *Genesis 19:17-23*
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Group notes

Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names Lot.

Old Testament

Genesis 18:22–33	Abraham pleads for Sodom, where Lot lives
Genesis 19:29	"God remembered Abraham, and sent Lot out"
Deuteronomy 2:9, 19	Land given to "the children of Lot"
Psalms 83:8	The "children of Lot" among Israel's enemies
Echo: Ruth 4:13–17	Ruth the Moabitess, ancestor of David

New Testament

Luke 17:28–32	"The days of Lot"; "Remember Lot's wife"
2 Peter 2:6–9	God "delivered just Lot," vexed by the wicked's way of life
Echo: Hebrews 11:10	Abraham "looked for a city which hath foundations"

For discussion

- Observe:* What did Lot see when he chose the plain, and what does Genesis add right after (Genesis 13:10–13)?
- Understand:* Peter calls Lot "righteous." How does that fit with what Genesis shows about his choices?
- Apply:* Lot moved toward Sodom one step at a time. What small step toward something harmful do you need to reverse?
- Apply:* Lot lingered even when rescue was offered. Where are you delaying something God has already made clear?